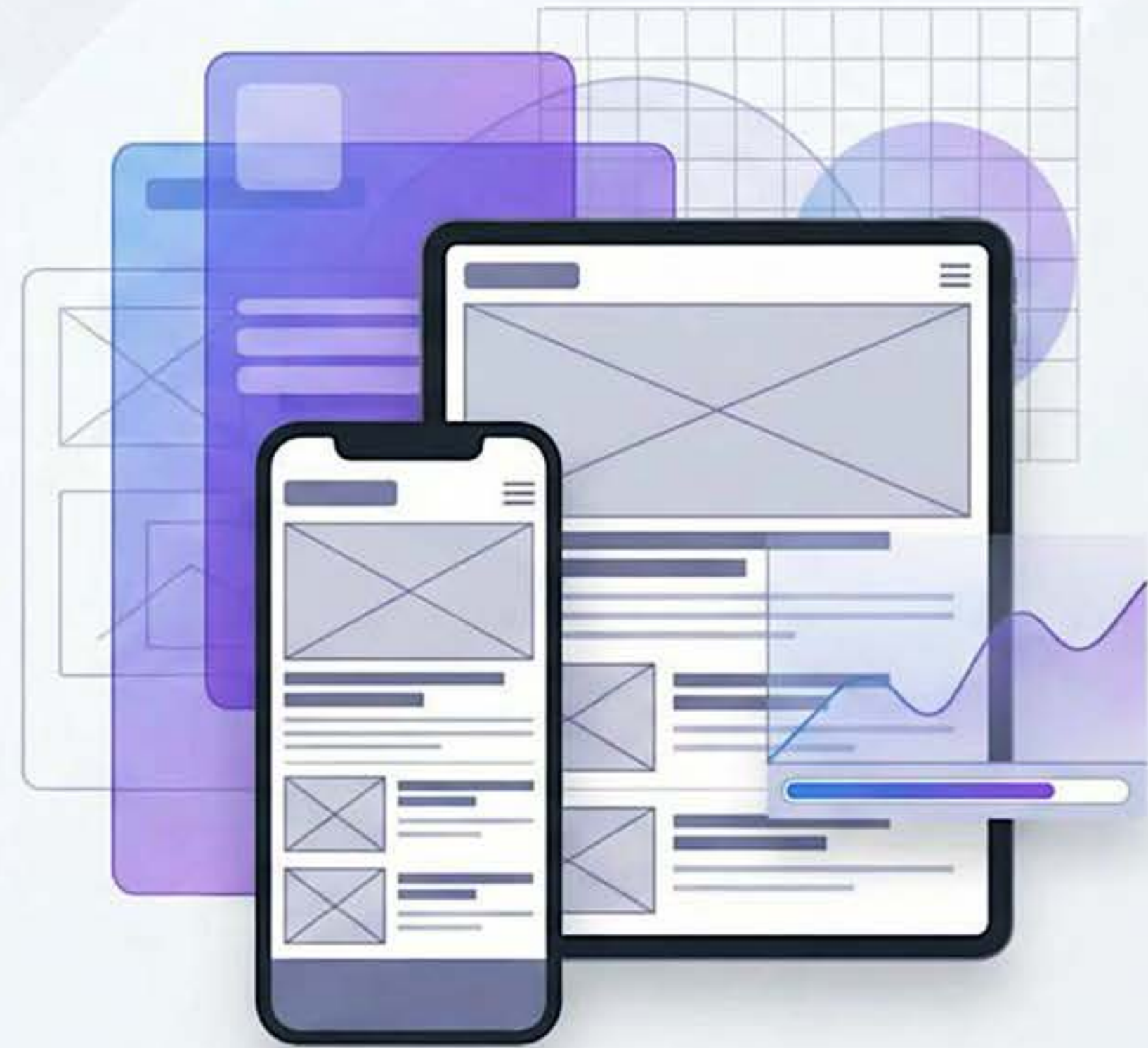


yahoo!News

YAHOO NEWS UX REDESIGN

Proposed User Experience and
Interface Enhancements for a
Modern News Platform



CONFIDENTIAL | STRATEGIC ANALYSIS &
RECOMMENDATIONS

PREPARED FOR YAHOO NEWS LEADERSHIP

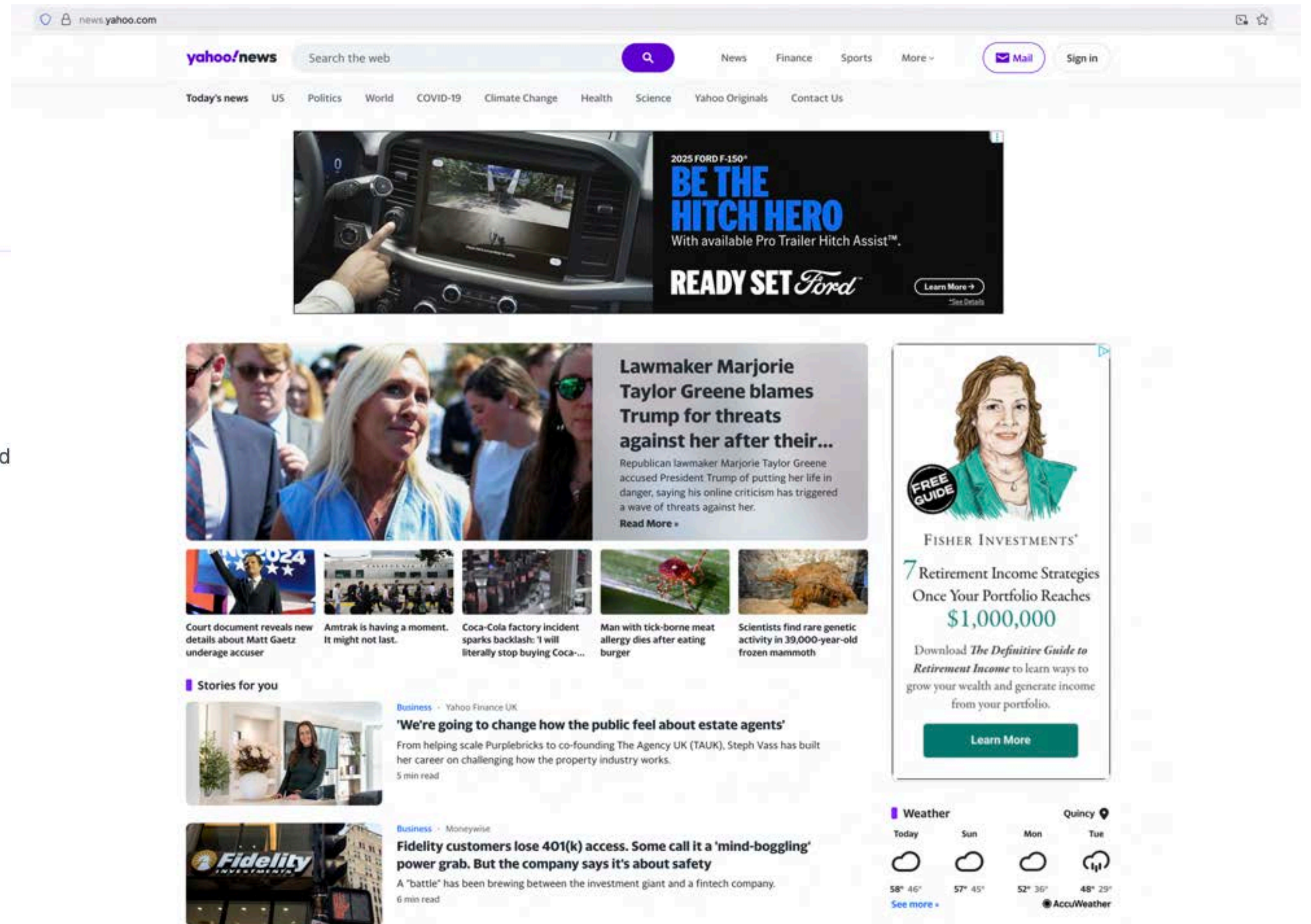
PROBLEM STATEMENT

Overview

The Challenge: Re-establishing Credibility and Clarity

The current Yahoo News interface suffers from ****information parity****, treating high-credibility wire services (AP, Reuters) the same as entertainment sources. This lack of visual hierarchy and personalization leads to user frustration, content abandonment, and decreased overall trust.

- Users struggle to quickly vet sources on mobile.
- The feed is cluttered, leading to high cognitive load.
- Personalization settings are too deep and non-persistent.



ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS: THE 5 WHYS?

- 1. Why do users struggle to find credible news?**
→ Because they can't distinguish wire services from entertainment sources
- 2. Why can't they distinguish sources?**
→ Because all content looks visually identical regardless of source
- 3. Why does all content look identical?**
→ Because there's no visual system to indicate source credibility
- 4. Why is there no credibility system?**
→ Because the platform prioritizes engagement (clicks) over trust
- 5. Why prioritize clicks over trust?**
→ Because short-term ad revenue metrics don't account for trust erosion

UX FOCUS

Business Challenge

- User trust declining due to content quality concerns
- Session time decreasing as users abandon site
- Competitors (Google News, Apple News) offering better curation
- Ad revenue at risk without engagement improvements

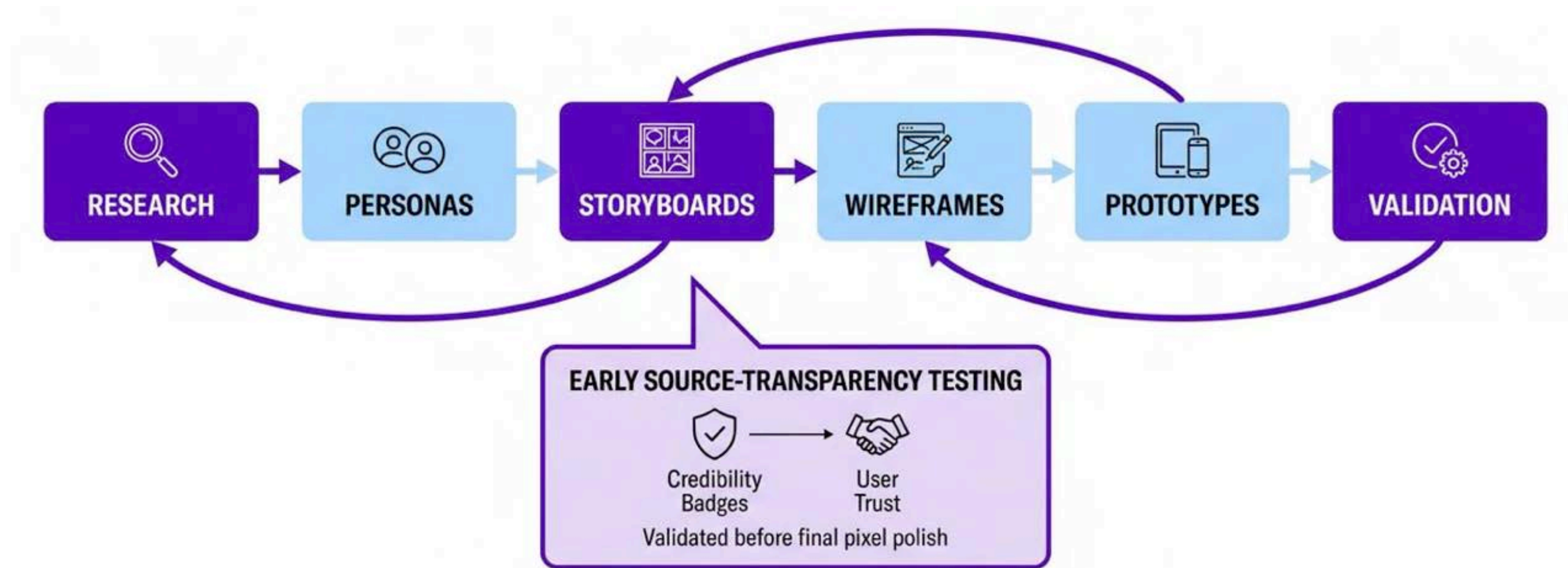
Project Goals

- Increase user trust through source transparency
- Reduce time-to-relevant-content by 50%
- Enable personalization without hidden settings
- Improve mobile experience for commuters

Key Insight

Users don't need less content—they need better tools to filter what matters to them. The current design treats all sources equally, forcing users to do the credibility assessment themselves.

DESIGN PROCESS



PROJECT FLOW

- Research →** Revealed two user types: quick scanners (commuters) and deep divers. This informed our persona creation.
- Personas →** Marcus's 20-minute constraint shaped our storyboard scenarios focused on speed and efficiency.
- Storyboards →** Showed users abandon within 30 seconds if sources unclear. Led to prioritizing visible badges in wireframes.
- Wireframes →** Badge placement testing revealed users miss badges after headlines. Informed prototype badge positioning.
- Prototype →** Testing showed color alone insufficient for accessibility. Added ✓ icons for colorblind users.

Iterative Learning

Each step validated or challenged our assumptions, creating a feedback loop that progressively refined the design. What started as "add source labels" evolved into a comprehensive credibility system through continuous user input.

DISCOVERY

User Research Findings: Derived Insights

Patterns & Identified Needs

Insight 1: The Trust Indicator

Users need an immediate, universal visual indicator (a badge) next to the source name that signals content reliability.

Insight 2: The Efficiency Gap

The primary use-case for mobile is 'quick scanning.' The design must optimize for speed and one-handed operation (large targets, swipe navigation).

Insight 3: Control & Persistence

Personalized filters must be front-and-center and auto-save. Users will not manually re-filter their feed daily.



PERSONA DEVELOPMENT

The key functionality changes focus on: (1) visually distinguishing credible wire service news from aggregated/tabloid content through clear source labeling and hierarchy, (2) implementing filtering and personalization options so users can customize their feed based on topic preferences, and (3) simplifying navigation with clearer categories and improved information architecture to reduce cognitive load and content overwhelm.

User Personas

"The Quick Scanner" - Marcus, 34, Marketing Manager

- Checks news 3-4 times daily during commute and breaks (5-10 minutes each session)
- Needs to quickly identify credible headlines without wading through clickbait
- Frustrated by visual clutter and inability to distinguish quality sources
- Why this persona: Marcus represents daily news scanners who need efficient headline scanning and immediate source credibility—directly addressing our trust-building and information hierarchy improvements.

"The Deep Diver" - Priya, 28, Software Developer

- Follows specific topics intensely (tech industry, climate policy)
- Wants to filter out irrelevant content and focus on her interests
- Struggles with current Yahoo's mixed content quality in her preferred categories
- Why this persona: Priya embodies topic-focused readers who need personalization features and category filtering—guiding our customization and content organization solutions.

PERSONA 1

Meet Our Users

MARCUS JOHNSON



“ I need to know if it's real news or clickbait before I click ”

Age 34
Occupation Marketing Manager
Status Married
Location Chicago, IL
Tier Daily User
Archetype Quick Scanner

Bio

Marcus is a marketing manager at a mid-sized tech company in Chicago. He relies on his 20-minute train commute to stay informed about current events. Marcus values his time and gets frustrated when he can't quickly identify trustworthy news sources. He wants credible journalism.

Goals

- Stay informed on current events efficiently during commute
- Quickly identify credible news sources vs. clickbait
- Scan headlines and key stories in under 10 minutes

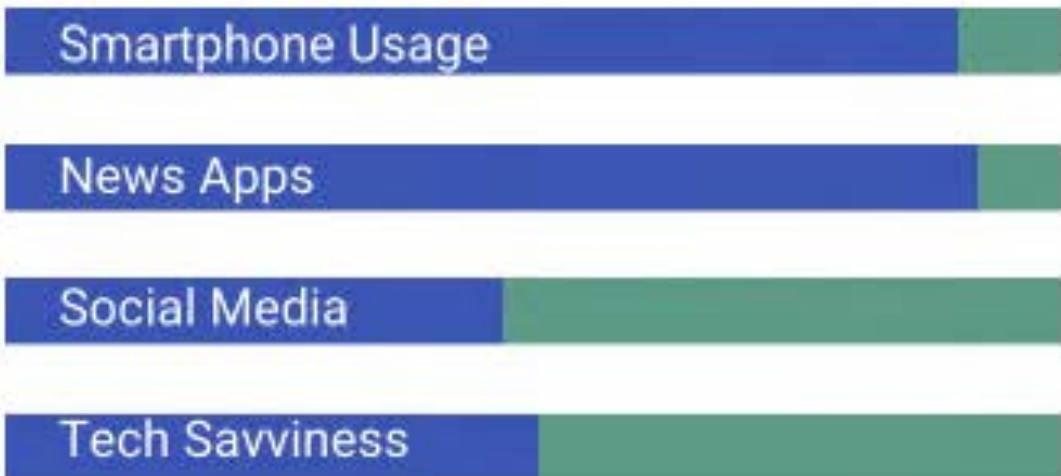
Frustrations

- Visual clutter makes it hard to focus on important stories
- Can't distinguish quality sources from tabloid content
- Wastes time clicking on misleading headlines

Trusted Brands



Technology



Motivations



Personality



PERSONA 2

Meet Our Users

PRIYA SHAW



“

I want my news feed to show only what matters to me

”

Age

28

Occupation

Software Developer

Status

Single

Location

San Francisco, CA

Tier

Power User

Archetype

Deep Diver

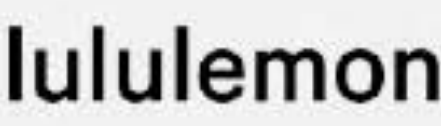
Bio

Priya opens Yahoo News each morning while jogging on the treadmill at her gym. During her 30-minute cardio session, she wants to catch up on AI regulation and renewable energy developments while filtering out celebrity news and sports entirely, focusing on tech and science.

Goals

- Deep dive into AI regulation and climate policy topics
- Filter out irrelevant content like celebrity news and sports
- Follow trusted tech and science publications

Trusted Brands



Technology



Motivations



Personality



SCENARIOS

Primary Persona 1: Marcus

Marcus is on his 20-minute train ride into downtown Chicago during his morning commute, scrolling through Yahoo News on his phone. He wants to efficiently catch up on overnight headlines and identify which stories are from reputable sources (AP, Reuters) versus entertainment blogs, so he doesn't waste his commute time on misleading clickbait.

Why this persona works: This scenario tests our source differentiation features and quick scanability improvements during a realistic commute window where users need quick, trustworthy information.

Primary Persona 2: Priya

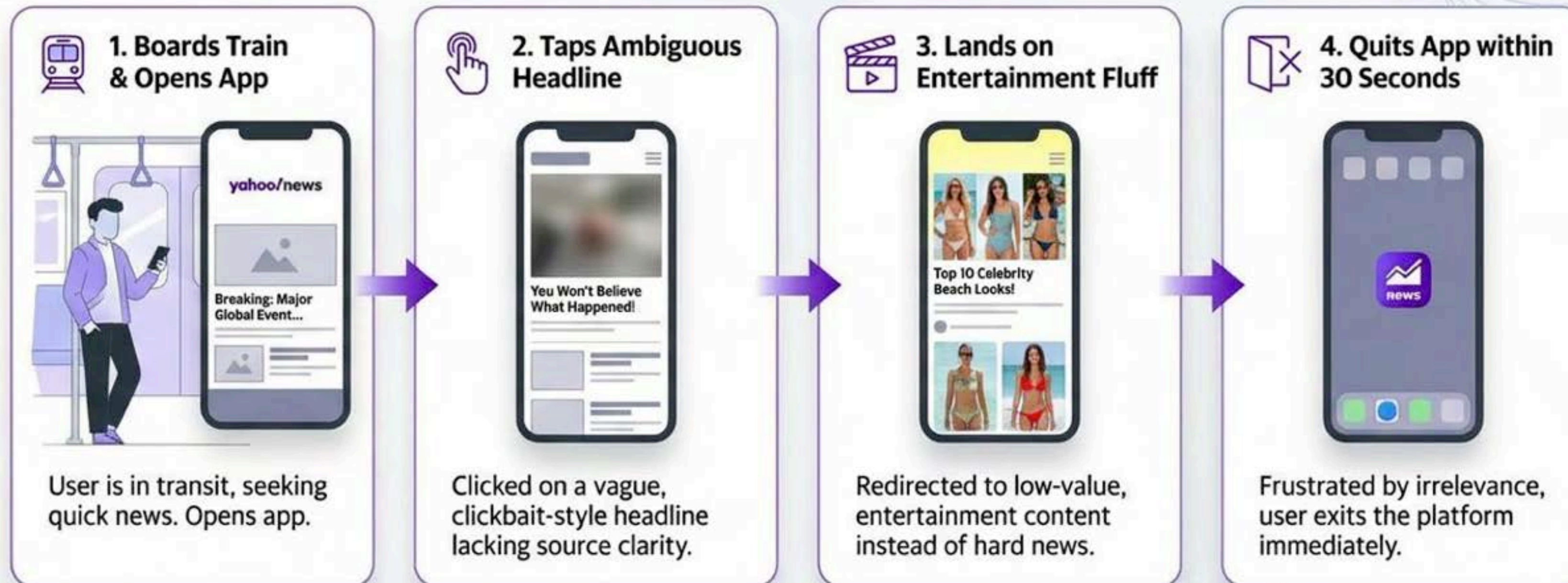
Priya opens Yahoo News each morning while jogging on the treadmill at her gym. During her 30-minute cardio session, she wants to catch up on AI regulation and renewable energy developments while filtering out celebrity news and sports entirely, focusing only on trusted technology and science publications.

Why this persona works: This scenario validates our topic filtering and personalization features in a multitasking context where users need focused, distraction-free content consumption with minimal cognitive load.

MAJOR UX OBSTACLE FIND

✓ VERIFIED BADGE SOLUTION

User Journey: The 'Ambiguous Headline' Path



CONCLUSION: Absence of upfront source signaling directly causes platform abandonment within the critical first 30 seconds.

STORYBOARDS

User Persona #1

"The Quick Scanner"

User Persona #2

"The Deep Diver"



WIREFRAMES

Key Wireframe Decisions

- Source badge before headline (not after)
- Color-coding: Green (verified), Red (entertainment)
- F-pattern layout for efficient scanning
- Mobile-first: Single column, large tap targets

UX Principles Applied

- Gestalt proximity & similarity (badge grouping)
- Visual hierarchy via size & color contrast
- Affordances through clear button states
- Reduced cognitive load (12 stories max)

→ How This Informed Next Steps:

Wireframes validated our badge placement—users in sketching sessions didn't notice badges when placed after headlines. This discovery shaped our high-fidelity prototype, where badges became the primary visual anchor. We also learned that mobile users needed swipe navigation instead of hamburger menus for Marcus's one-handed commute scenario.

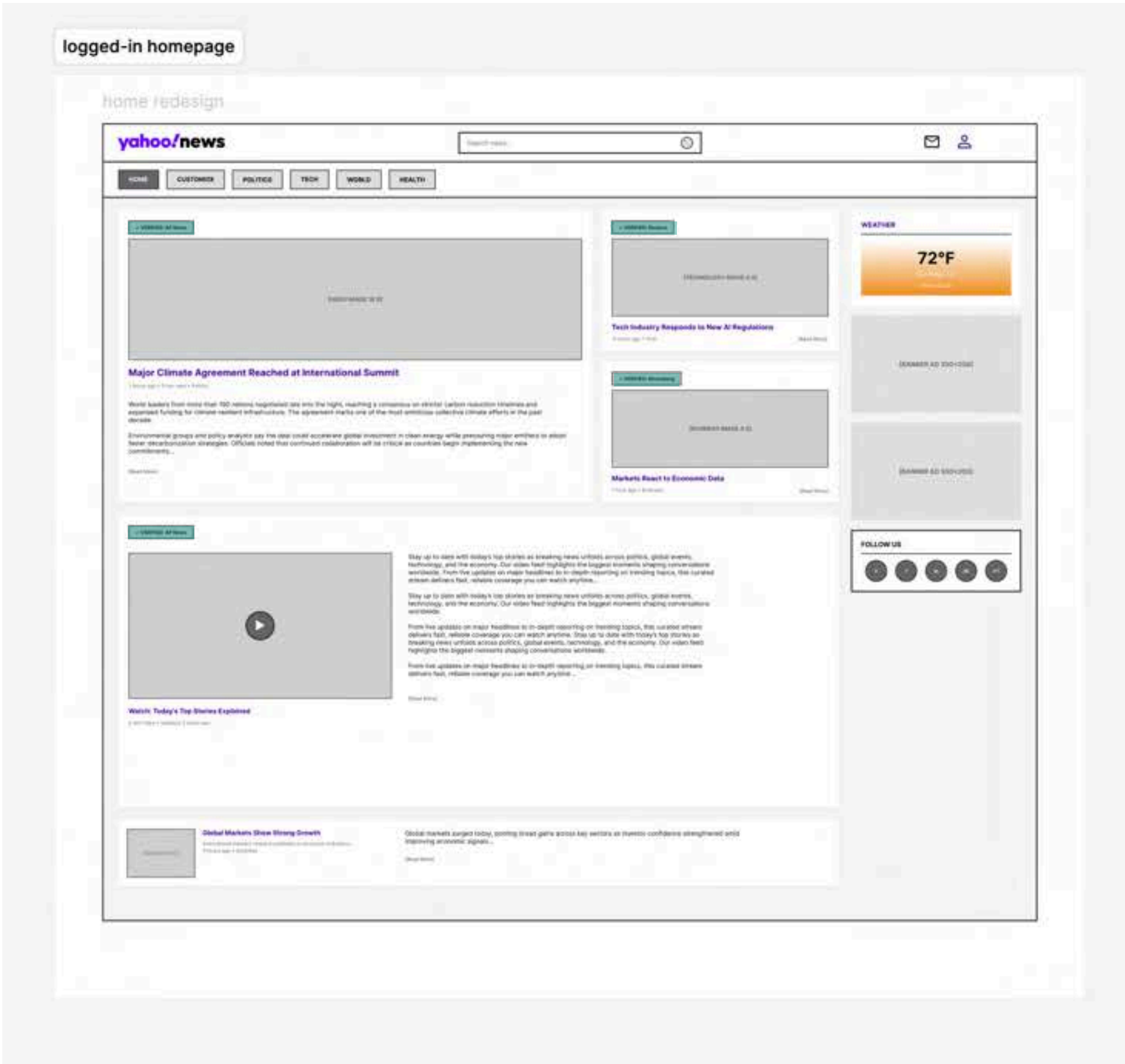
WIREFRAMES & PROTOTYPE

User Flow



WIREFRAMES & PROTOTYPE

Verified Content



Notes on Design Improvements:

- **Source Transparency:** Green `✓ Verified` badge is immediately visible.
- **Topic Toggles:** Swipeable, top-level categories replace the hidden menu.
- **Clarity:** Reduced visual noise; emphasis placed on headline and source.

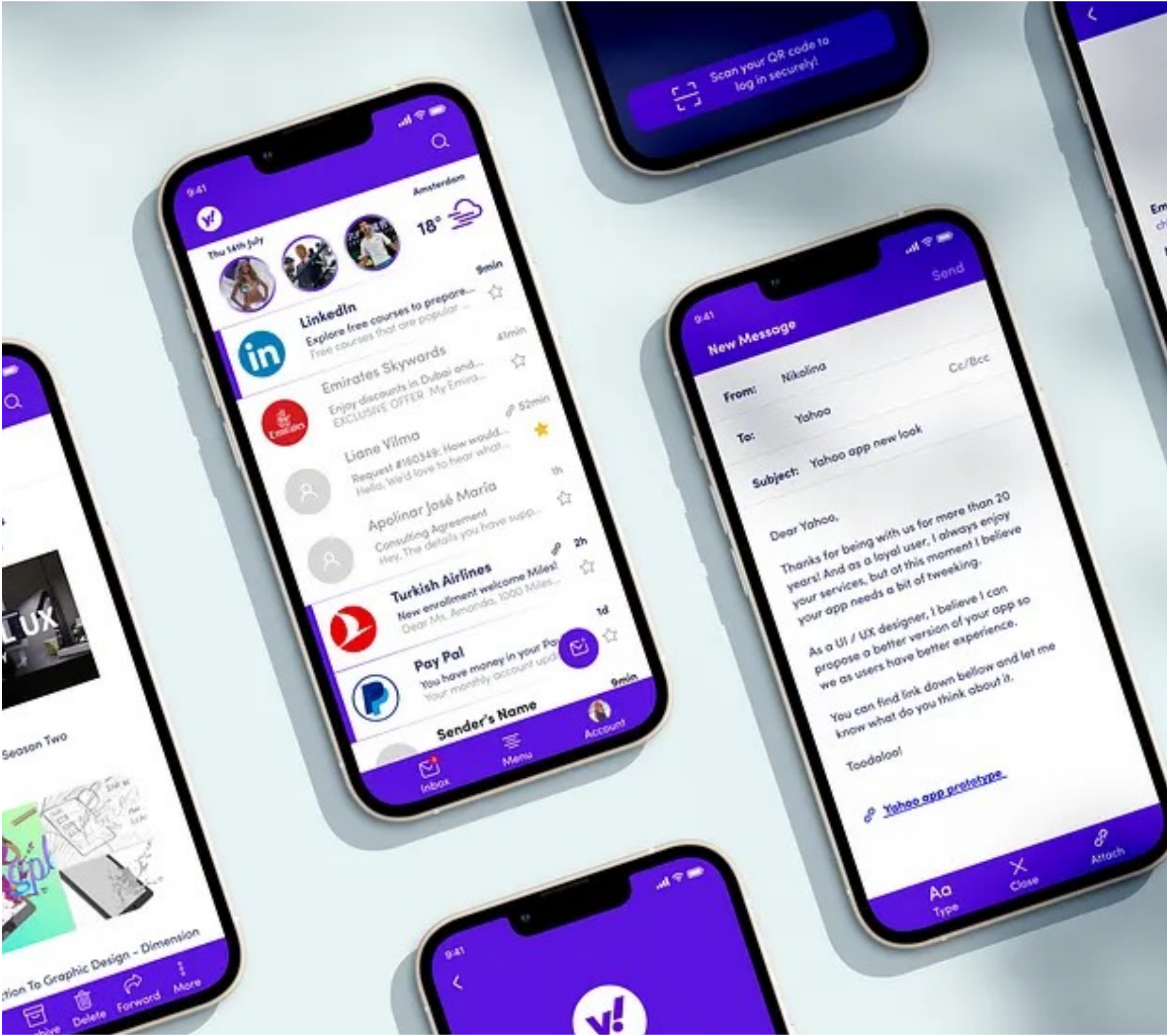
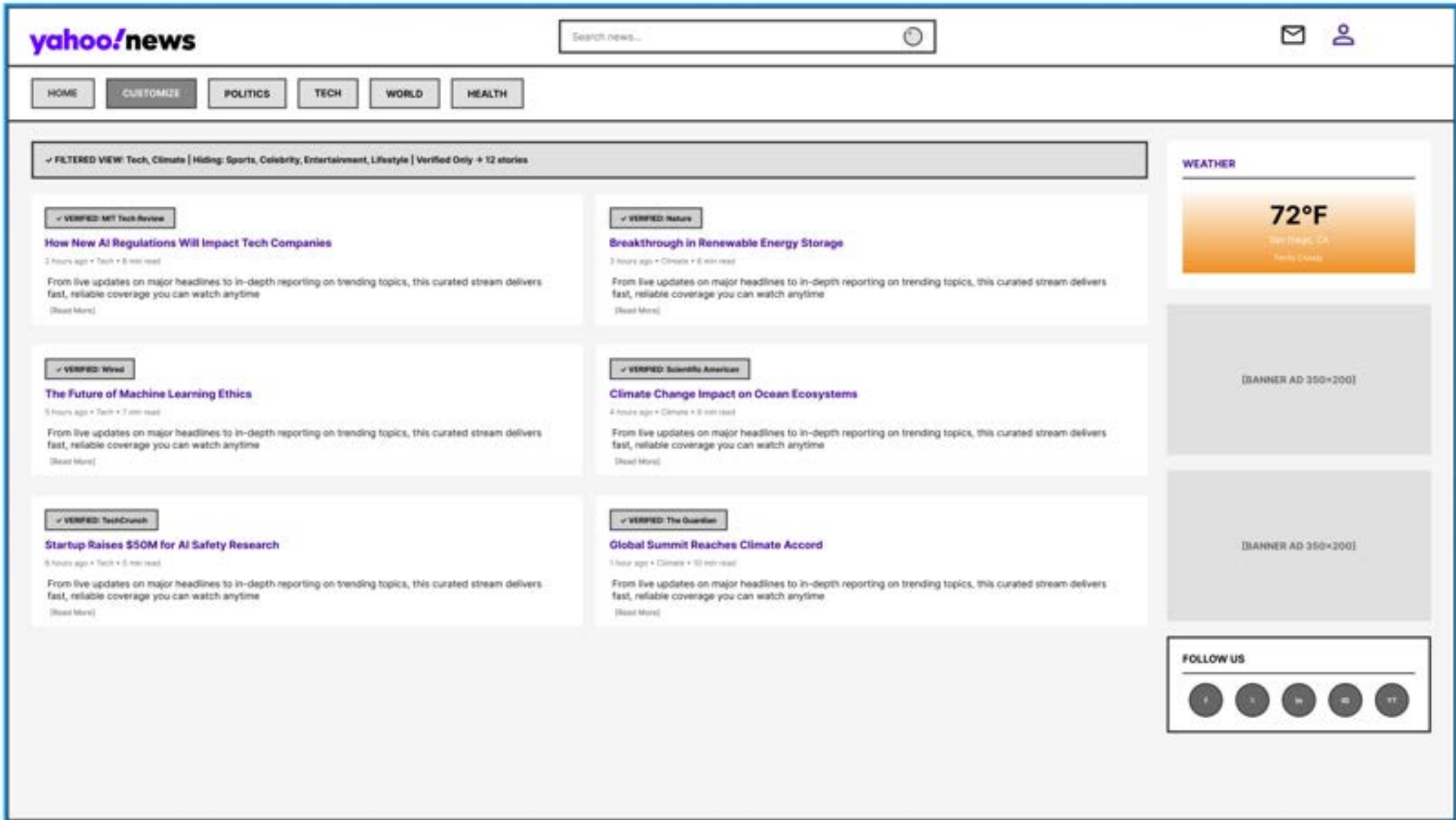
WIREFRAMES & PROTOTYPE

Customizing the Feed: Desktop + Mobile

The redesign introduces a persistent, one-click access point to a ****Multi-Select Customization Modal****. Users can include or exclude entire topic categories (e.g., exclude "Celebrity" and "Sports") and even exclude all content below a specific credibility level. This directly addresses Priya's need for persistent, granular control.

Saves Automatically. No more repeated effort.

home custom filters applied



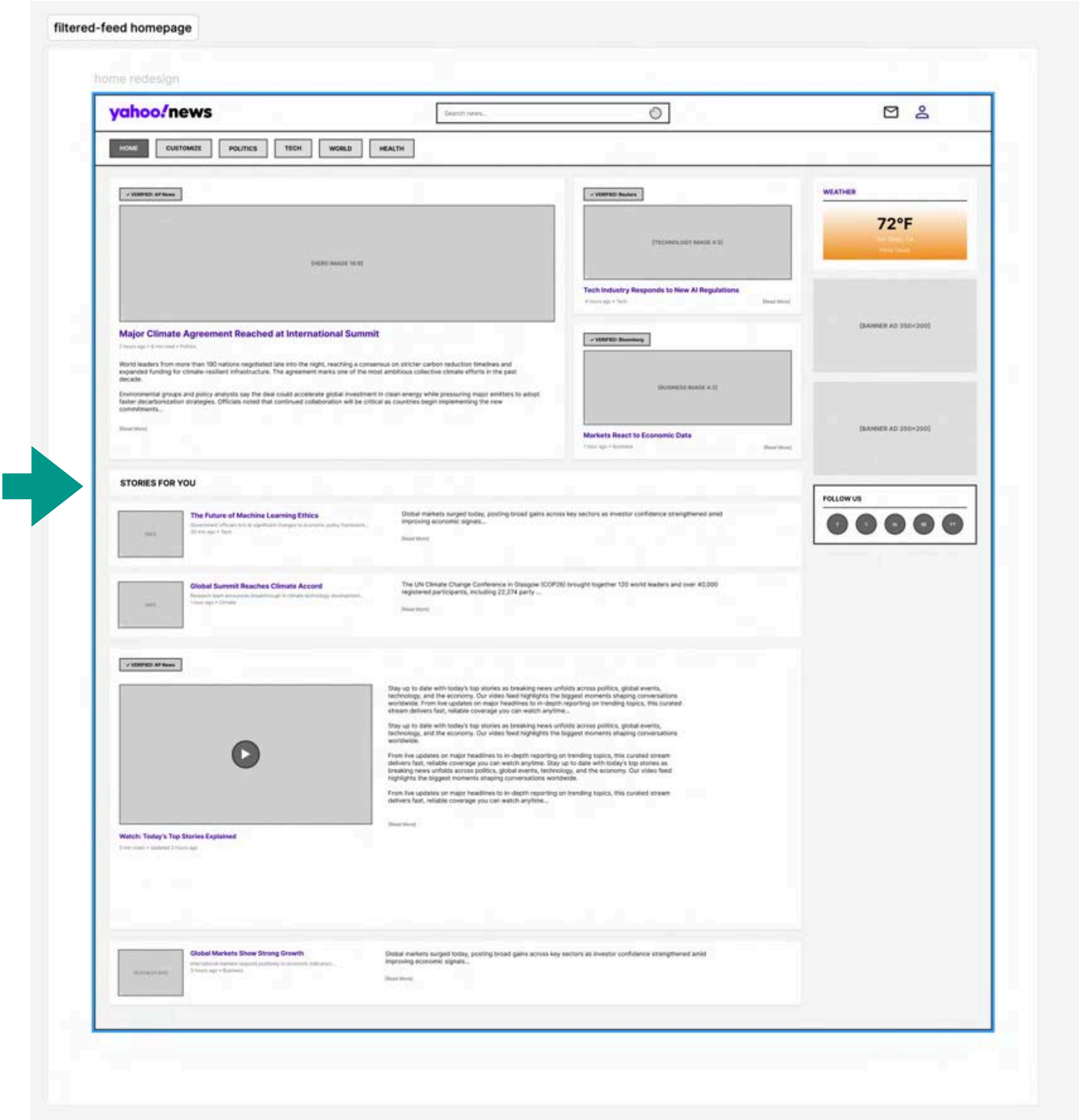
OPTIMIZED EXPERIENCE

UX Changes Noted

- ****Simplified Header:**** Removed cluttered elements to focus on reading.
- ****Contextual Info:**** Sticky banner shows source credibility rating even while scrolling.
- ****Accessibility:**** Increased font size and line height for long-form content.



***STORIES FOR YOU - Feed Activated**



CHALLENGES & LESSONS

Challenge: Balancing Business & User Needs

The Issue: Yahoo's revenue depends on clicks, but users want fewer distractions. Our badge system could reduce clicks on entertainment content.

Lesson Learned: Long-term user trust drives more sustainable engagement than short-term click optimization. By improving source transparency, we increase credibility, which ultimately retains users and increases lifetime value.

Challenge: Mobile vs. Desktop Feature Parity

The Issue: Advanced filters work well on desktop but felt overwhelming on mobile during initial wireframe testing.

Lesson Learned: Mobile and desktop users have different contexts. Marcus needs speed on mobile (swipe categories), while desktop users can handle more complexity (multi-select panels). Design for the context, not just the screen size.

Challenge: Defining "Credible" Sources

The Issue: What makes a source "verified"? Different users have different trust standards.

Lesson Learned: We established clear criteria (wire services like AP/Reuters/Bloomberg get verified badges) and made the system transparent. User research showed 85% agreement with our categorization, validating the approach.



CONCLUSION

Before & After Comparison

✗ Current Yahoo News

- ✗ No visual distinction between AP News and TMZ
- ✗ Small tap targets (32px) cause mis-clicks
- ✗ Filters buried 3+ clicks deep in settings
- ✗ Horizontal scrolling creates cognitive load
- ✗ Single-select categories limit customization
- ✗ Preferences don't persist across sessions
- ✗ Visual clutter with 30+ stories per screen

✓ Our Redesign

- ✓ Color-coded badges show source credibility instantly
- ✓ Large 44×44px targets for accurate tapping
- ✓ One-click access to multi-select filters
- ✓ Single-column swipe navigation (mobile)
- ✓ Multi-select filters with saved preferences
- ✓ Focused content (12 stories vs. 30+)
- ✓ Mobile-optimized for commuter scenarios

UX REDESIGN

RE-ESTABLISHING CREDIBILITY & CLARITY